23 – Everyday workflows & prompt library

AI Training for Beginners

Self-study training: use AI/LLMs safely in everyday life

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https://github.com/mgunthner/AI-Training

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Contents

23 – Everyday workflows & prompt library **1**
Key points 1
Example 1
Do / Don’t 2
Mini checklist 2
Exercise (5 min.) 2
Next 2

23 – Everyday workflows & prompt library

Definition: A **workflow** is a fixed sequence of steps for a recurring task. The **prompt library** is your collection of tried-and-tested prompts for it – built once, used again and again.

> **Remember:** Getting a good result once is luck. Making it repeatable is method.

Key points

- **Spot recurring tasks:** Anything you do more than once (summarizing emails, building study plans, evaluating spreadsheets) is worth a workflow.
- **Structure of a workflow:** Starting point → prompt (from the library) → check the quality → save/adjust.
- **Library structure per entry:** title, purpose, the finished prompt, example result (anonymized), if needed a note (which model, which setting).
- **Mini quality check before using it:** Is it correct (facts, figures)? Am I allowed to share it (data, rights, topic 22)? Is it my style (tone, length)?
- **When AI, when not:** AI for text, structure, ideas, routine. Not for tasks where reliability or the relationship matters and you can’t check it (contracts, conflicts, personal messages to people close to you).
- **Maintenance:** Review your library regularly – sort out or sharpen up prompts that no longer work.

Example

Eight standard workflows to start with (all with made-up data):

1. **Summarize and answer email:** Paste the email → “Summarize this and suggest three reply variants: short, friendly, formal.”
2. **Summary:** Paste the text → “Summarize in five bullet points, audience: a manager with no specialist knowledge.”
3. **Study plan:** State the topic and time budget → “Create a plan as a table, at most one topic per day, day 7 off.”
4. **Research preparation:** “Ask the 10 questions you need answered before you research.”
5. **Text revision:** Text + “Improve clarity and structure. Don’t change the meaning. List your changes at the end.”
6. **Spreadsheet help:** Paste the raw data → “Turn this into a table with sensible columns and point out anything notable.”

7. **Decision preparation:** Describe the situation → “Create a pros and cons table with the three most important criteria on each side.”
8. **Meeting preparation:** Topic list → “Create an agenda with time blocks and one objective per item.”

Library entry (template):

Field	Content
Title	Email triple reply
Purpose	Respond quickly and in a structured way to incoming emails
Prompt	“Summarize the following email in 2 sentences and suggest 3 reply variants: short and concise, friendly-neutral, formal. Email: [TEXT]”
Example result	Three variants of 3–5 sentences each, made-up customer “Person A”
Note	Works better without the thinking mode

Do / Don’t

Do	Don’t
Save every successful prompt right away	Start from scratch and reword every time
Check results before using them	Fill library entries with real data
Improve prompts iteratively	Keep failed prompts without reworking them

Mini checklist

- ☐ I have set up a notes file as my prompt library.
- ☐ I have my first three entries with title and purpose.
- ☐ I check every result with the mini quality check.
- ☐ I rework entries that no longer deliver.

Exercise (5 min.)

Pick one of the eight standard workflows. Test it in your chat with made-up data. If the result fits: save the prompt and the example result (anonymized) as your first library entry. If not: improve the prompt over two rounds and then save it.

Next

- Extra exercises: `02_extra_exercises/23_extra_exercises`
- Test: Test F (Final)
- Related: 05 Prompt basics, 06 Prompt techniques, 18 Skills, 22 Legal & compliance

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